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OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY
FEDERAL MARITIME COMMISSION

December 13, 2011

Ms. Karen V. Gregory
Secretary
Federal Maritime Commission
800 North Capitol Street, NW
Washington, DC 20573-0001

Subject: Docket No. 11-19, *U.S. Containerized Cargo Flows – Response to NOI*

Dear Madam Secretary:

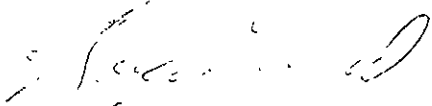
Chicago Southland Economic Development Corporation (CSEDC) is submitting these comments in response to the Federal Maritime Commission's Notice of Inquiry on factors that may cause or contribute to the shift of cargo destined for the U.S. inland from U.S. to Canadian and Mexican seaports.

CSEDC is an economic development corporation representing public and private organizations in the south Cook and eastern Will County. We focus on promoting new development based on the logistic assets of our region, particularly the CN Intermodal site located in south Cook County. In our region, with high unemployment of 20% in some communities, we project the full development of the CN site will yield 3,000 to 5,000 jobs.

Trade between the United States and Canada, as well as the ability to choose from among a variety of North American ports for imports and exports, are essential to the success of the businesses we represent. Currently the Canadian National Railroad is undertaking a major expansion of its intermodal facility located in Harvey, Illinois. This expansion promises to spur development throughout a number of our communities, many of which are economically disadvantaged. The Canadian National gateway at Prince Rupert connects directly to the Harvey Intermodal facility and is their main Chicago area terminal.

Thank you for the opportunity to comment on this issue. Please include this letter in the public docket for this proceeding.

Sincerely,



Reggie Greenwood
Executive Director

RG/sm